

Year 4 Grammar - Complex Sentences

Name: _____ Date: _____

ACARA v9.0 Alignment: AC9E4LA06 - understand that complex sentences include an independent clause and at least one dependent clause.

Learning Intention

I can build complex sentences by joining a main idea with a dependent idea.

Grammar Strategy

Use joining words such as because, when, although, if, before and after to add a dependent idea.

Vocabulary Helper

clause - a group of words with a verb

independent clause - a clause that can make sense on its own

dependent clause - a clause that needs another idea to complete it

Worked Example

The class stayed inside because heavy rain covered the oval.

Success Checklist

- ☐ I can name the grammar feature.
- ☐ I can use it in my own sentence.
- ☐ I can explain how it helps the reader.

Mini Practice

Join: I packed my bag. The bell rang.

Finish: Although the path was muddy,

_____.

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Warm Up

1. Circle the joining word: We waited because the bus was late.

2. Tick the sentence that has two ideas: The dog barked. / The dog barked when the gate opened.

Build Your Skills

1. Complete: When the storm passed, ____.

2. Join with because: The garden grew well. The students watered it.

3. Write a complex sentence using although.

Strong Challenge

Write a short paragraph with two complex sentences about a school event.

High Five!

You used grammar tools to make writing clearer. That is strong author thinking!

I Can Checklist

- ☐ I tried each section.
- ☐ I checked my sentence.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____

Next step: _____

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Answer Key and teaching support

Answer Key

1. because; The dog barked when the gate opened.
2. Examples: we went outside; The garden grew well because the students watered it.
3. Look for one main idea and one dependent idea.

Parent Tip - At Home

Make silly sentence starters: "Because the sandwich ran away..." Ask your child to finish with a main idea.

Teacher Tip - In Class

Use two colours: one for the main idea and one for the dependent idea. Students label both parts.

Mini Rubric

Look for: correct grammar feature, clear meaning, careful punctuation and a sentence that makes sense to the reader.